

being a team player. What he really was, though, was an unreasonably high-risk investor. Going all in on the single stock—even his own company's stock—cost him everything he had built over twenty years.

When you invest in single stocks, no matter what the company is, you're giving up all control. You're placing a bet on that one company, and there's nothing you can do to control the outcome. Maybe that's why none of the millionaires we studied mentioned single stock as a contributing factor to their wealth. You've got no control over a single stock. It's a bet with way too much risk. Millionaires aren't scared to say no to those kinds of risks. I know I'm not. I'm okay missing out on *potential* gains that could bring *probable* pain. I'm not going to risk my family's future on a single company's performance or the whims of the average consumer. Instead, like the millionaires we've studied, I'll take on a more reasonable degree of risk by investing in mutual funds. That still allows me to enjoy the growth of the stock market, but in a way that diversifies my risk. Instead of putting ten eggs in one basket, mutual funds give me the chance to put one egg in ten baskets. That way, if one basket crashes, I've got nine others to fall back on. If you want to know more about how all this works, check out my book *Retire Inspired*.